

25STCV25814 25STCV25814

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: 310

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Case Number: 25STCV25814 Hearing Date: August 7, 2026 Dept: 310

Tentative Ruling

Judge Kevin C. Brazile

Department 310

Hearing Date: August 7, 2026

Case Name: Law v. Activision Blizzard, Inc., et al.

Case No.: 25STCV25814

Matter: Motion for Protective Order

Motions to Compel Further Responses (4x)

Ruling: The Motion for Protective Order is granted in part.

Plaintiff's Motion to Compel as to Interrogatories is granted.

Plaintiff's Motion to Compel as to Documents is granted in part.

Defendants' Motion to Compel as to Interrogatories is granted.

Defendants' Motion to Compel as to Documents is granted in part.

Defendants to give notice.

The Court encourages all parties to appear remotely via LA CourtConnect. If submitting on the Court's tentative ruling, please follow the instructions provided above.

This is an employment action.

There are five discovery motions at issue now.

Protective Order

Defendants Activision Blizzard, Inc. and Sledgehammer Games, Inc. seek a protective order that distinguishes between confidential and highly confidential designations.

Good cause must be shown for the protective order, and the issuance and formulation of the protective order are within the Court's discretion. (See, e.g., *Mercury Interactive Corp. v. Klein* (2007) 158 Cal.App.4th 60, 106-7; *Raymond Handling Concepts Corp. v. Superior Court* (1995) 39 Cal.App.4th 584, 588.)

The Court will enter its standard, model protective order with only ordinary confidential designations. Defendants failed to carry their burden to show justification for a highly confidential designation. The focus of this case is apparently Plaintiff's communication abilities.

The Motion is granted in part as set forth herein. No sanctions.

Plaintiff—FI employment

Plaintiff seeks to compel Sledgehammer to provide further responses to her form interrogatories, employment.

The Motion is granted. Defendant's boilerplate objections lack merit and now that a protective order has been entered, there is no basis not to identify or produce the subject documents.

Further responses are to be served within 20 days. No sanctions.

Plaintiff—Documents

Plaintiff seeks to compel Sledgehammer to provide further responses to her requests for production.

The Motion is granted in part.

For RFP no. 11, Defendant should produce a privilege log if a privilege applies.

The Motion is denied as to RFP no. 14, which is overbroad.

For the remaining RFPs, Defendant's boilerplate objections lack merit and now that a protective order has been entered, there is no basis not to identify or produce the subject documents.

Further responses are to be served within 20 days. No sanctions.

Defendants—FI general

Defendants seek to compel further response to their form interrogatories, general, from Plaintiff.

The Motion is granted. The responses are incomplete and/or the objections lack merit. The term "incident" should in good faith be construed to mean Plaintiff's termination. (*Deyo v. Kilbourne* (1978) 84 Cal.App.3d 771, 783.)

Further responses are to be provided within 20 days.

No sanctions.

Defendants—Documents

Defendants seek to compel further response to their requests for production from Plaintiff.

The Motion is denied as to RFP nos. 54 and 62, which are overbroad.

As to the remaining RFPs, the responses are deficient and the objections lack merit. If there is a privilege, then a privilege log should be provided. If Plaintiff cannot produce documents because they do not exist, Plaintiff should also affirm a diligent search and inquiry.

The Motion is granted in part. Further responses are to be provided within 20 days.

No sanctions.

Defendants to give notice.